

Thomas Leavitt

ASSISTANT PROFESSOR

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ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Baruch College, City University of New York (CUNY) Assistant Professor (tenure track), Marx School of Public and International Affairs Affiliate, CUNY Institute for Demographic Research (CIDR)	2023–
Harvard University Postdoctoral Research Fellow, Harvard Medical School	2021–2023

AFFILIATIONS

Arnold Ventures Criminal Justice Evaluation Network Evaluation and Evidence Consulting Fellow	2026–
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EDUCATION

Columbia University Political Science	Ph.D., 2021
<i>Dissertation:</i> “Design-based, Bayesian Causal Inference for the Social Sciences” <i>Committee:</i> Donald P. Green (chair), Macartan Humphreys (sponsor), Naoki Egami, Jake Bowers (external, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign), Fredrik Sävje (external, Yale University)	
<i>Visiting Affiliation:</i> Harvard University, Ivy Plus Exchange Scholar (2019–2020)	
University of Chicago Committee on International Relations (CIR)	M.A.
DePauw University Political Science	B.A.
Additional Graduate Coursework <i>ICPSR Summer Program, University of Michigan</i> Maximum Likelihood Estimation I: Generalized Linear Models Regression Analysis II: Linear Models Introduction to Statistics and Data Analysis I and II	2013 2012 2012

PUBLISHED AND FORTHCOMING ARTICLES

- Leavitt, T. Beyond Pretrends: A Discordance-Based Sensitivity Analysis for Difference-in-Differences. Accepted at *Observational Studies*.
- Leavitt, T. and L. W. Miratrix. Building a Design-Based Matching Pipeline: From Principles to Practical Implementation in R. Accepted at *Observational Studies*.
- Leavitt, T. and V. Rivera-Burgos. (In press). Navigating the Mismeasurement of Intermediary Variables in Message-Based Experiments. *Political Science Research and Methods*, First View. DOI: 10.1017/psrm.2025.10082
- Leavitt, T. (2026). Fisher Meets Bayes: The Value of Randomisation for Bayesian Inference of Causal Effects. *International Statistical Review*, 94(1), 188–201. DOI: 10.1111/insr.12598
- Leavitt, T. and L. A. Hatfield. (2025). Averaged Prediction Models (APM): Identifying Causal Effects in Controlled Pre-Post Settings with Application to Gun Policy. *The Annals of Applied Statistics*, 19(3), 1826–1846. DOI: 10.1214/25-AOAS2011

Leavitt, T. and V. Rivera-Burgos. (2024). Audit Experiments of Racial Discrimination and the Importance of Symmetry in Exposure to Cues. *Political Analysis*, 32(4), 445–462. DOI: 10.1017/pan.2024.3

Leavitt, T. (2023). Randomization-Based, Bayesian Inference of Causal Effects. *Journal of Causal Inference*, 11(1), 20220025. DOI: 10.1515/jci-2022-0025

PUBLISHED BOOK CHAPTERS

Green, D. P., T. Leavitt, and D. Markovits (2023). Challenges that Proprietary Research Poses for Meta-Analysis. In J. M. Box-Steffensmeier, D. P. Christenson, and V. Sinclair-Chapman (Eds.), *Oxford Handbook of Engaged Methodological Pluralism in Political Science*, Volume 1, Chapter 18, pp. 257–271. New York, NY: Oxford University Press. Print edition 2026. DOI: 10.1093/oxfordhb/9780192868282.013.21

Bowers, J. and T. Leavitt (2020). Causality and Design-Based Inference. In L. Curini and R. Franzese (Eds.), *The SAGE Handbook of Research Methods in Political Science and International Relations*, Volume 2, Chapter 41, pp. 769–804. Thousand Oaks, CA: SAGE Publications. DOI: 10.4135/9781526486387.n44

ARTICLES UNDER REVIEW

Leavitt, T., J. Bowers, and L. W. Miratrix. Sequential Sensitivity Analysis for Multiple Assumptions: A Framework for Understanding Racial Disparity in Police Use of Force. Revise & resubmit at *Journal of the American Statistical Association*. arXiv:2605.21893

Leavitt, T. Which Effect of Race? Causal Inference without Holding All Else Equal. Submitted. arXiv:2607.16371

STATISTICAL SOFTWARE

Leavitt, T., Hatfield, L., & Greifer, N. (2025). *apm: Averaged Prediction Models*. R package version 0.1.1. DOI: 10.32614/CRAN.package.apm. Documentation: tl2624.github.io/apm/

OTHER WRITINGS

Zeldow, B., T. Leavitt and L. A. Hatfield. Difference-in-Differences. diff.healthpolicydatascience.org

INVITED AND COMPETITIVE PRESENTATIONS

Invited Session “Robust Causal Inference Under Real-World Complications” SLDS 2026 Conference on Statistical Learning and Data Science ASA Section on Statistical Learning and Data Science	<i>Nov 2026 (Scheduled)</i>
Data Science Frontiers: Society and Politics New York University (NYU) Abu Dhabi Institute NYU Abu Dhabi	<i>Oct 2025</i>
Methods Workshop Department of Political Science Vanderbilt University	<i>Nov 2024</i>
Data Science Cluster Meeting Baruch College, CUNY	<i>Apr 2024</i>
Political Methodology Colloquium Department of Political Science Columbia University	<i>Feb 2024</i>
Winter Workshop on Causal Inference and its Applications Departments of Statistics and Economics University of Florida	<i>Jan 2024</i>

Department of Political Science Washington University in St. Louis	<i>Oct 2023</i>
Invited Paper Session “Planning observational studies with unobserved confounding in mind” Joint Statistical Meetings	<i>Aug 2023</i>
Data Science Lunch Seminar Series The Center for Data Science New York University	<i>Mar 2023</i>
Conference of the ERCIM WG on Computational and Methodological Statistics (15th) CFE-CMStatistics King's College London	<i>Dec 2022</i>
Applied Statistics Workshop The Institute for Quantitative Social Science Harvard University	<i>Oct 2022</i>
Quantitative Methods Workshop Wilf Family Department of Politics New York University	<i>Oct 2022</i>
Pre-APSA Workshop “Knowledge Accumulation and External Validity: Implications for Design and Analysis” Evidence in Governance and Politics (EGAP) Centre for the Study of Democratic Citizenship (CSDC) McGill University	<i>Sep 2022</i>
The Miratrix C.A.R.E.S. Lab Graduate School of Education and Department of Statistics Harvard University	<i>Mar 2021</i>
Columbia Business School and Chazen Institute for Global Business Columbia University	<i>Jan 2020</i>
Quantitative Methods Workshop Wilf Family Department of Politics New York University	<i>Apr 2019</i>

TEACHING

Quantitative Methods 2: Statistical Theory and Causal Inference (Doctoral) <i>Political Science Department</i> <i>Columbia University</i>	<i>Spring 2027</i>
Applied Quantitative Research II (Doctoral) <i>Political Science Department</i> <i>The Graduate Center, CUNY</i>	<i>Fall 2026</i>
Causal Inference for the Social Sciences (Doctoral) <i>ICPSR Summer Program</i> <i>University of Michigan</i>	<i>Summers 2018–2024, 2026</i>
Data Collection and Description (Master's) <i>Marxe School of Public and International Affairs</i> <i>Baruch College, CUNY</i>	<i>Spring 2027</i>
Public Affairs Capstone Seminar (Master's) <i>Marxe School of Public and International Affairs</i> <i>Baruch College, CUNY</i>	<i>Fall 2026</i>

Advanced Quantitative Methods (Master's)
Marxe School of Public and International Affairs
Baruch College, CUNY

Fall 2024, Spring 2025

Causal Analysis and Inference (Master's)
Marxe School of Public and International Affairs
Baruch College, CUNY

Spring 2024, Fall 2024, Spring 2025

Data Analysis for Public Service (Master's)
Marxe School of Public and International Affairs
Baruch College, CUNY

Fall 2023, Spring 2024

Political Systems of Africa (Undergraduate)
Political Science Department
City College of New York, CUNY

Spring 2018

SERVICE

Referee

The American Political Science Review; The American Statistician (2x); Journal of Causal Inference; Observational Studies; Philosophy of Science; Political Analysis (3x); Political Science Research and Methods; Statistics in Medicine

Marxe School of Public and International Affairs

Assessor, Program Learning Assessment (HEA and MPA)

AY 2025–26

Member, Learning Assessment Committee

AY 2023–24, 2024–25

Peer Teaching Observer (PAF 9335, PAF 9134, PAF 4401)

AY 2023–24, 2024–25

Columbia University

Coordinator, Methods Workshop

AY 2016–17

President, Political Science Graduate Student Council (PSGSC)

AY 2015–16

Coordinator, Contemporary African Political Economy Research Seminar (CAPERS)

Fall 2015

* Note: HEA = Higher Education Administration; MPA = Master of Public Administration.

GRANTS AND FELLOWSHIPS

Winter Workshop Travel Award

2024

Department of Statistics and Department of Economics

University of Florida

American Causal Inference Conference (ACIC) Junior Researcher Grant

2022

National Science Foundation (NSF)

Dissertation Development Grant

2018

Department of Political Science

Columbia University

Proposal Development Grant

2017

The Abdul Latif Jameel Poverty Action Lab (J-PAL)

Massachusetts Institute of Technology

Student Research Grant

2016

Center for Development Economics and Policy (CDEP)

Columbia University

Seed Grant

2015

Center for the Study of Development Strategies (CSDS)

Columbia University

ADDITIONAL TRAINING

Research Certifications

CITI Program (Collaborative Institutional Training Initiative)

Responsible Conduct of Research

Sep 2026

Human Subjects Research (Social and Behavioral)

Sep 2026

Pedagogical Training

HyFlex Seminar

Spring 2025

Center for Teaching and Learning, Baruch College, CUNY

Seminar on Inclusive Pedagogy

Spring 2024

Bernard L. Schwartz Communication Institute, Baruch College, CUNY

Professional Development

Understanding the Jewish Experiences and Antisemitism

Jan 2024

NYC Commission on Human Rights

Human Rights Law, Racism and Other Forms of Discrimination Based on Race and Color

Dec 2023

NYC Commission on Human Rights

At-Risk Mental Health for Faculty & Staff

Sep 2023

Kognito

Mandatory CUNY and New York State Trainings

Current as of AY 2026–27

Ethics, Cybersecurity Awareness, Workplace Violence Prevention, ESPARC, and Title VI

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages

R (including tidyverse), Stan, Wolfram Language

Development

Git and GitHub, R package development (CRAN), Shiny

Authoring

$\LaTeX$, R Markdown and Quarto

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

American Political Science Association (APSA)

Society for Political Methodology (SPM)

Society for Causal Inference (SCI)